

FAQs

Machine auto-shuts down in a minute!

Q. I run Windows XP Professional, and I've recently gotten a broadband connection. I didn't have anti-virus software when I got the connection. Now, all of a sudden, I've started receiving a message that says, "NT Authority/system call, Remote Procedure Call service terminated. The system will shut down within one minute." I installed Norton AntiVirus 2003, but it isn't working at all. I then tried to run navdx.exe in DOS mode, but it doesn't detect a virus. What might the problem be?

Saptarshi

A. The solution to your problem involves three steps. First, download the virus removal tool for the Blaster virus—this is the virus that has infected your machine—available at <http://securityresponse.symantec.com/avcenter/FixBlaster.exe>. Second, the virus may return if you do not patch your Windows, so install the Windows patch available at <http://download.microsoft.com/download/9/8/b/98bcbfad8-afbc-458faaeb7a52a983f01/WindowsXP-KB823980-x86-ENU.exe>.

The final step is to download the latest virus definitions, located at <http://securityresponse.symantec.com/avcenter/download/us-files/20040311-033-i32.exe>. If the shutdown error message occurs while downloading any of the fixes mentioned above, go to **Start > Run**, type **'shutdown -a'** and press **[Enter]** to get rid of it temporarily.

Reducing flicker

Q. Ever since I upgraded to Windows XP, the refresh rate of my monitor has become exceptionally slow. It refreshes slowly when I try to scroll down the screen. Can you help me resolve this?

Milan

A. All you need to do is increase the refresh rate. Right-click anywhere on the desktop and select Properties. Go to the Settings tab, click Advanced and switch to the Monitor tab. Here, set the 'Screen refresh rate' to the highest possible value. For a 17-inch monitor at 1024 x 768, the maximum refresh rate is around 85 Hz while it is 70 Hz for a 15-inch monitor at 800 x 600. These settings do vary from model to model

and vendor to vendor.

Also, do use the VGA card drivers provided by the vendor for better hardware acceleration in the display, making it scroll faster. You may also reduce the number of colours your display is set to in the Settings tab.

Works in one, but not in the other

Q. Somehow my Riva TNT128 AGP card does not install properly in Windows 98. The display goes blank once I reboot it after the driver installation. I have a dual-boot PC that runs Windows XP and Windows 98 on a BXv98-AT board with 128 MB RAM. The card works fine with Windows XP, though. I am using the drivers CD that was bundled with the card.

Pradip Srivastav

A. Ensure that the appropriate driver files are selected while installing the driver in Windows 98. If there is no wrong being done in the driver file selection, then probably the drivers themselves are corrupt. Download and install the detonator from http://www.nvidia.com/object/LO_20010606_3499.html.

Opening ISO files

Q. I have a Pentium III 866 MHz, Windows 98 SE, 256 MB of RAM, Award BIOS, and a 20 GB hard disk. I often save images of CDs on my hard disk using Nero 5.5. What software should I use for opening these image files, which are in the .iso format?

Abhinav

A. There are many applications that open ISO files. Some of them are WinISO, available from www.winiso.com, UltraISO from www.ultraiso.com and WinRAR available at www.rarlab.com.

No display

Q. I have a Pentium III 800 MHz with Windows 98 SE and a Mercury 810 motherboard. My problem is that there is no display on my monitor. As I boot up my PC, the monitor goes into standby and there is no activity at all. Please help me.

Tejas

A. First, verify if the monitor is working properly. Remove the display cable from the VGA port at the back of the cabinet. The monitor should then display a message that reads something like this: "No connection, Check signal cable". Older monitors may not display anything. Connect them to another working computer to test their functionality.

The next step would be to check whether the SMPS is working. If its fan is not working then the problem is with the SMPS. You will have to get it repaired.

If all's well with the SMPS, then check the internal speaker. To do that, remove the RAM chips from the motherboard and boot up the PC. The speaker should generate some sound, if not then get a proper working speaker, as it's an important component in the troubleshooting process. If the speaker works, and yet you hear no beeps indicating the removal of the RAM, then the motherboard or processor is at fault. Get them serviced.

However, if the speaker does beep then insert the RAM back into the slot and remove the display card. Now the speaker should beep again. If it doesn't, then there is a problem with the motherboard. If the speaker beeps then the display card is at fault; get it replaced or repaired, insert the new or repaired display card and the monitor should work fine.

The last step would be to check if the CPU fan is working. If it isn't, then again the motherboard is at fault. Verify the working of the fan using an alternate computer.



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E-mail us your computing problems, and we may answer them here! Since we get more

mails per day than we can handle, it may take some time for your query to be answered. Rest assured, we are listening!